



Reality check

While the 13-day tournament showcased fierce competition on the turf, it simultaneously exposed glaring systemic financial deficiencies in hockey. Excluding established nations such as India, Germany, Belgium, Australia, Argentina, Spain and the Netherlands, many participating teams faced severe financial obstacles simply to attend the event. Several resorted to crowdfunding, while the majority

were self-funded by players' families and friends. "Obviously, every camp you go to, you pay for," said New Zealand player Milan Patel. "When we went to the Sultan of Johor Cup a couple of weeks ago, we paid for that. It's not easy... I think, luckily, we have sponsorships from family friends and a lot of fundraising on tour." The presence of family members in the stands offered a poignant display of the profound passion that drives athletes in sport.

Honour board



Men's

Gold - Germany
Silver - Spain
Bronze - India

Women's

Gold - Netherlands
Silver - Argentina
Bronze - Belgium

Indian women fall short in Chile



The Indian women finished a disappointing 10th at the FIH Hockey Junior World Cup 2025 in Santiago, Chile.

Despite dominant wins over lower-ranked sides, a crucial 1-3 loss to Germany in the pool stage meant it missed the quarterfinals on goal difference. The team struggled with consistency and penalty-corner conversions in the classification matches, ultimately falling 1-2 to Spain in the ninth-10th place play-off. In the final, the Netherlands sealed its third consecutive title after defeating Argentina.